
HOW

Paths to Transdisciplinary Education for Researchers

Researchers can primarily participate in transdisciplinary education in two ways: as initiators or by joining an existing project.

Much transdisciplinary education arises from enthusiastic researchers—sometimes, but not always, also working as teachers—seeking collaboration with educational and societal partners. These researchers act as pioneers: they make a plan, find like-minded enthusiasts, and try to gain support within their institution.

With the growth of transdisciplinary projects within higher education institutions, researchers can also join existing initiatives. Institution-wide events or national conferences are excellent opportunities to connect with other innovators. Network organizations like Comenius (for education in the Netherlands) and social media platforms like LinkedIn offer inspiration and networking opportunities.

Societal partners also approach academic institutions with project proposals. Publicly expressing your interest in transdisciplinary projects increases the chance of getting connected to collaborations.

During the TRAIL, you will learn about the different phases of transdisciplinary education, whether you are pioneering or joining an existing initiative. The first phase involves setting up the team and collaboration. The next phase focuses on developing the project. Then comes the phase of participation and creating outcomes. The final phase is about evaluation, with a view to new challenges.